CBSE CLASS X – ENGLISH LANGUAGE & LITERATURE

MID-TERM EXAMINATION 2026–27

Time Allowed: 3 Hours Maximum Marks: 80

GENERAL INSTRUCTIONS

1. This question paper contains **12 questions**. All questions are compulsory.
2. The question paper is divided into three sections: Section A – Reading Skills (20 Marks), Section B – Writing Skills with Grammar (20 Marks), and Section C – Literature Textbook (40 Marks).
3. Attempt questions according to the specific instructions given for each question.
4. Internal choices are provided in some questions.
5. Maintain the prescribed word limit wherever mentioned.
6. Answers should be relevant, precise and grammatically correct.
7. Read the questions carefully before answering.

SECTION A – READING SKILLS (20 MARKS)

Q1. Read the following passage carefully. (10 Marks)

In today's fast-paced world, people often believe that productivity means doing several things at the same time. Students may listen to music while studying, check notifications while completing homework and switch between different tasks rapidly. However, research and experience suggest that multitasking does not always make a person more efficient. Instead, constantly shifting attention can reduce concentration and increase the chances of making mistakes.

Deep focus is becoming an increasingly valuable skill. It refers to giving complete attention to one meaningful task without unnecessary distractions. When students study with focus, they understand concepts better and remember information for a longer period. Even a short period of concentrated study can sometimes be more useful than several hours of distracted work.

Technology is not entirely responsible for distraction. The way individuals use technology matters greatly. Smartphones, for example, can provide educational resources, dictionaries and learning applications. At the same time, excessive notifications and social media can interrupt important tasks. Therefore, developing self-discipline is essential.

One effective method is to create specific periods for focused work. During these periods, students can keep unnecessary devices away and concentrate on a single objective. Short breaks between study sessions can also refresh the mind. Gradually, such habits help individuals improve their ability to concentrate.

In the future, the ability to focus may become even more important. While technology continues to make information easily available, understanding and using that information wisely will require concentration. True productivity, therefore, is not about doing more things at once but about doing important things with complete attention.

I. What is the central idea of the passage? (1)

a) Technology should be completely avoided by students.
b) Multitasking is the best way to increase productivity.
c) Focused attention is more effective than constant multitasking.
d) Students should study for longer hours.

II. According to the passage, multitasking may lead to: (1)

a) better memory b) increased concentration c) more mistakes d) faster learning

III. Complete the following sentence appropriately: (1)

Deep focus means giving complete attention to _____ without unnecessary distractions.

IV. Why does the writer say that technology is not entirely responsible for distraction? (1)

V. Select the option that best describes the tone of the passage. (1)

a) Humorous b) Informative and advisory c) Critical and angry d) Emotional

VI. Mention one benefit of taking short breaks during study sessions. (1)

VII. What does the phrase *"self-discipline"* mean in the context of the passage? (1)

a) Depending on others for motivation

b) Controlling one's behaviour and distractions
c) Studying continuously without breaks
d) Avoiding all forms of technology
VIII. How can students develop the habit of deep focus? Answer in about 30–40 words. (2)
IX. Explain why the writer considers concentration an important skill for the future. Answer in about 30–40 words. (2)

Q2. Read the following case-based factual passage and study the table carefully. (10 Marks)

Reading habits among teenagers have changed considerably over the last few years. While printed books remain popular, digital reading platforms, educational websites and audiobooks have also become common sources of information. A survey was conducted among **200 students** of Class X to understand their preferred reading material.

Type of Reading Material	Number of Students
Printed Books	70
Educational Websites	50
E-books	35
Newspapers/Magazines	25
Audiobooks	20

The survey revealed that printed books continue to be the most preferred source of reading among students. Many students stated that physical books help them concentrate better. Educational websites occupied the second position because of easy access to updated information.

E-books were preferred by students who appreciated portability and convenience. Newspapers and magazines were chosen mainly by students interested in current affairs and general knowledge. Audiobooks, though least preferred, were appreciated by students who liked listening while travelling or relaxing.

The survey clearly shows that traditional and digital forms of reading can coexist. Instead of replacing one another, different formats serve different purposes and preferences.
I. Which reading material was preferred by the maximum number of students? (1)
a) E-books b) Printed Books c) Audiobooks d) Newspapers
II. How many students preferred digital educational websites? (1)
III. Which two categories together account for 60 students? (1)
a) E-books and Newspapers/Magazines b) Audiobooks and Printed Books
c) Educational Websites and Audiobooks d) Newspapers/Magazines and Audiobooks
IV. Why were educational websites popular among students? (1)
V. What can be inferred from the popularity of printed books? (1)
a) Students dislike technology completely.
b) Physical books still help many students concentrate effectively.
c) Digital reading has disappeared.
d) Only teachers prefer printed books.
VI. State whether the following is True or False: Audiobooks were preferred by more students than newspapers and magazines. (1)
VII. What percentage of students preferred e-books? (1)
a) 17.5% b) 25% c) 35% d) 50%
VIII. Why does the passage suggest that traditional and digital reading formats can coexist? Answer in about 30–40 words. (2)
IX. Which reading format would you personally prefer for academic learning and why? Answer in about 30–40 words. (2)

SECTION B – WRITING SKILLS WITH GRAMMAR (20 MARKS)

GRAMMAR

Q3. Complete ANY TEN of the following twelve tasks, as directed. (10 × 1 = 10)

I. Fill in the blank with the correct form of the verb:
By the time we reached the auditorium, the programme _____ already _____. (begin)

II. Identify the error and supply the correction:
Neither of the boys were present in the classroom.
III. Fill in the blank using a suitable modal:
Students _____ respect the rules of the examination hall.
IV. Choose the correct option to complete the sentence:
My sister _____ in Delhi since 2022.
a) lives b) lived c) has been living d) is living
V. Fill in the blank with a suitable determiner:
_____ information provided by the librarian was useful.
VI. Choose the correct option:
Each of the players _____ given a certificate.
a) were b) have c) was d) are
VII. Fill in the blank with the correct form of the verb:
If it _____ tomorrow, we will stay indoors.
a) rains b) rained c) will rain d) has rained
VIII. Identify the error and supply the correction:
One of my friend have won the competition.
IX. Fill in the blank with a suitable determiner:
There are _____ apples left in the basket.
a) little b) a little c) few d) much
X. Choose the correct modal:
You _____ wear a helmet while riding a two-wheeler.
a) might b) should c) could d) would
XI. Fill in the blank with the correct tense:
The students _____ for the examination these days.
a) prepare b) are preparing c) prepared d) have prepared
XII. Fill in the blank with an appropriate determiner:
I have _____ idea about the topic.
a) a b) an c) the d) some

WRITING SKILLS

Q4. Attempt ANY ONE of the following in about 100–120 words. (5 Marks)

A. You are **Subham, a resident of Haddo, Sri Vijayapuram**. Write a letter to the Editor of a national daily expressing your concern about the excessive use of mobile phones by teenagers. Suggest suitable measures to promote responsible digital habits.

OR

B. You are **Shivani, Class X-A**. Write a letter to the Principal of your school requesting the introduction of a **"Reading Hour"** every week to develop reading habits among students.

Q5. Attempt ANY ONE of the following in about 100–120 words. (5 Marks)

A. Analytical Paragraph

Method of Preparation	Percentage of Students
Self-study	40%
Coaching Classes	25%
Group Study	20%
Online Learning	15%

Write an analytical paragraph analysing the information given above.

OR

B. Analytical Paragraph

Activity	Number of Students
Sports	45
Music	30

Debate	20
Art	35
Dance	25

Write an analytical paragraph based on the given information.

SECTION C – LANGUAGE THROUGH LITERATURE (40 MARKS)

Q6. Read the given extracts and answer the questions for ANY ONE of the two extracts. (5 × 1 = 5)

A. Extract from Prose

Nelson Mandela believed that freedom was not merely the ability to live without chains. True freedom meant living with dignity and allowing others to live freely too. He realised that both the oppressed and the oppressor lose their humanity in an unjust system.

I. According to Mandela, true freedom includes: a) political power only b) living with dignity and respecting others' freedom c) freedom from education d) personal success

II. The word *"oppressed"* refers to people who are: a) powerful b) treated unfairly and denied freedom c) highly educated d) wealthy

III. What does Mandela mean when he says that the oppressor also loses humanity?

IV. Mandela's idea of freedom reflects the value of: a) selfishness b) equality and human dignity c) revenge d) competition

V. What can we infer about Mandela's personality from the extract?

OR

B. Extract from Prose

Anne Frank often found it difficult to share her deepest thoughts with people around her. Although she had family and acquaintances, she felt the need for a true friend who could patiently listen to her feelings. This need encouraged her to express herself honestly through her diary.

I. Why did Anne begin writing a diary? a) To complete a school assignment b) To record only historical events c) To express her personal thoughts and feelings d) To improve her handwriting

II. Anne's diary became important because it acted as her: a) teacher b) silent companion c) examination notebook d) travel guide

III. The extract highlights Anne's need for _____.

IV. Which quality of Anne is reflected through her habit of writing honestly? a) Insincerity b) Self-awareness c) Laziness d) Carelessness

V. What does Anne's relationship with her diary teach us about self-expression?

Q7. Read the given extracts and answer the questions for ANY ONE of the two extracts. (5 × 1 = 5)

A. Extract from Poetry – A Tiger in the Zoo

The tiger moves silently inside the limited space of the zoo. His strength and natural freedom contrast sharply with his helpless confinement. The poet presents the animal as powerful by nature but restricted by human-made boundaries.

I. The tiger's confinement creates a contrast between: a) courage and fear b) freedom and captivity c) wealth and poverty d) darkness and light

II. The tiger is naturally associated with: a) weakness b) dependence c) power and freedom d) laziness

III. What is the poet's attitude towards the tiger's captivity?

IV. The expression *"human-made boundaries"* suggests: a) natural forests b) restrictions created by humans c) freedom in nature d) protection from danger

V. What message does the extract convey about wild animals?

OR

B. Extract from Poetry – The Trees

The trees in the poem symbolically move away from the restricted indoor environment towards the open forest. Their movement represents the natural desire for freedom and the restoration of the balance between human life and nature.

I. The movement of the trees mainly symbolises: a) destruction b) freedom and return to nature c) fear of humans d) growth of buildings

II. The trees are shown moving towards the: a) classroom b) marketplace c) forest d) city

III. What does the restricted indoor environment symbolically represent?

IV. The poem mainly highlights the relationship between: a) machines and humans b) humans and nature c) teachers and students d) cities and villages

V. State one important message conveyed through the symbolic movement of the trees.

Q8. Answer ANY FOUR of the following five questions in about 40–50 words each. (4 × 3 = 12)

I. Nelson Mandela says that courage is not the absence of fear but the triumph over it. Explain this statement with reference to *Nelson Mandela: Long Walk to Freedom*.
II. How does Anne Frank's diary reveal the importance of self-reflection and honest expression?
III. What makes Coorg a unique place in India? Mention any three features described in the chapter.
IV. How does Valli's bus journey in *Madam Rides the Bus* reflect her curiosity, determination and independence?
V. What lesson does the life of Buddha teach us about suffering and human existence in *The Sermon at Benares*?

Q9. Answer ANY TWO of the following three questions in about 40–50 words each. (2 × 3 = 6)

I. How does the poet convey the pain of losing something precious in *The Ball Poem*?
II. What does the poem *Amanda!* reveal about the pressure and expectations experienced by children?
III. How does *The Trees* use symbolism to communicate the importance of freedom and nature?

Q10. Answer ANY TWO of the following three questions in about 40–50 words each. (2 × 3 = 6)

I. How did Mrs Pumphrey's excessive affection become harmful for Tricki in *A Triumph of Surgery*?
II. Hari Singh was a thief, yet he eventually decided to return to Anil. What brought about this change in him?
III. Compare Anil's and Hari Singh's personalities in *The Thief's Story*. How did they influence each other?

Q11. Answer ANY ONE of the following in about 100–120 words. (6 Marks)

A. "Freedom is meaningful only when it ensures dignity and equality for everyone." With reference to *Nelson Mandela: Long Walk to Freedom*, discuss how Mandela's understanding of freedom developed from personal freedom to freedom for all.

OR

B. Valli's journey was not merely a bus ride but an important step towards understanding the world beyond her village. Discuss the statement with reference to *Madam Rides the Bus*.

Q12. Answer ANY ONE of the following in about 100–120 words. (6 Marks)

A. "Love without understanding can sometimes become harmful." Discuss this statement with reference to *A Triumph of Surgery*. What important lesson does the story teach about responsible care?

OR

B. Hari Singh's transformation in *The Thief's Story* shows that kindness and trust can bring positive change in a person. Discuss the statement with suitable reference to the story.

— END OF QUESTION PAPER —

Section-wise Marks Distribution

Section	Component	Marks
A	Reading Skills	20
B	Writing Skills with Grammar	20
C	Literature	40
TOTAL		**80**